JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category 3: Road Safety & Public Safety

Module 3 - Traffic Signs & Road Symbols

🗐 Module Overview

This handbook is your complete, beginner-to-advanced guide to **Traffic Signs & Road Symbols** — every category of sign you will encounter on an Indian road, exactly what it looks like, and precisely what it means. Whether you are preparing for your driving test or simply want to read the road with confidence, this handbook is written so that you can read it once and never mistake one sign for another again.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to understand India's traffic signs and road symbols.

🎯 Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Identify the three core categories of Indian traffic signs by shape and colour alone
- Understand the major mandatory, cautionary, and informatory signs
- Recognise temporary, construction zone, and school zone signage
- Read highway signs, route markers, and kilometre stones correctly
- Understand road markings and symbols painted on the road surface
- Interpret traffic police hand signals correctly
- Avoid the most commonly confused sign pairs
- Know the penalties for ignoring mandatory signs

🚦 Why This Topic Matters

A traffic sign only works if the person looking at it understands it instantly — there is rarely time to stop and think while moving at 60 km/h. Every sign on an Indian road follows a strict, standardised design, governed by the Indian Roads Congress, precisely so that its meaning can be read from shape and colour alone, in a fraction of a second.

> **Reality Check:** MoRTH data shows that overspeeding, wrong-side driving, and signal or sign violations together account for the large majority of India's road accidents. Many of these begin with a sign that was missed, misread, or ignored. A faded "School Ahead" board or a red "No Entry" circle is not decoration — it is a legally binding instruction with real safety consequences.

This is why learning to truly *read* signs — not just recognise their outline — is central to safe driving anywhere in India.

🕮 Introduction

Traffic Signs & Road Symbols are the standardised boards, markings, and gestures that communicate rules, warnings, and information to every road user, without relying on language.

In India, their legal authority comes from the **Motor Vehicles Act, 1988**, while their exact design, shape, colour, and placement are standardised nationwide by the **Indian Roads Congress (IRC)** — primarily through **IRC:67-2012** (Code of Practice for Road Signs) and **IRC:35** (road markings). This is why a "Stop" sign looks identical in Kerala, Kashmir, and Kolkata.

Sign Family	Purpose
Mandatory Signs	Legally enforceable instructions — must be obeyed
Cautionary Signs	Warn of hazards or unusual conditions ahead
Informatory Signs	Provide directions, distances, and facility information
Temporary Signs	Communicate short-term changes such as roadwork or diversions

🧠 Fundamental Concepts

Before going deeper, let us understand a few foundational ideas that the rest of this module is built upon.

What Is a Traffic Sign?

> **Traffic Sign** — A standardised board, marking, or signal placed on or near a road to instruct, warn, or inform road users, designed to be understood instantly from its shape, colour, and symbol.

The Shape-Colour Code

India's sign system is built on a simple, universal rule: shape and colour alone tell you the category of a sign, before you even read the symbol inside it.

- **Circle, red border:** Mandatory — an instruction you must obey
- **Triangle, red border, apex up:** Cautionary — a hazard to watch for
- **Rectangle, blue or green:** Informatory — helpful, not legally binding

Two signs deliberately break the circle rule, so they remain recognisable even when damaged, faded, or seen from an odd angle: the **Stop** sign (an octagon) and the **Give Way** sign (an inverted triangle).

Key Definitions

- **Regulatory Sign** — Another name for a mandatory sign; legally enforceable
- **Warning Sign** — Another name for a cautionary sign
- **Guide Sign** — Another name for an informatory sign
- **Supplementary Plate** — A smaller text board fitted below a main sign to add detail, such as distance or timing

🖨 Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — Mandatory (Regulatory) Signs

Mandatory signs carry the force of law — ignoring one is a punishable offence. Most are circular with a red border on a white background, but there are two important exceptions used for the two most safety-critical instructions:

Sign	Shape & Colour	Meaning
Stop	Octagon, red, white text	Come to a complete halt before proceeding
Give Way	Inverted triangle, red border	Yield to traffic on the road you are entering
No Entry	Solid red circle, white horizontal bar	No vehicle may enter in that direction
One Way	Red circle with a crossed-out arrow, or a rectangular directional arrow	Traffic may move only in the direction shown
Speed Limit	Red circle with a number	Maximum legal speed, in km/h, for that stretch
Horn Prohibited	Red circle, crossed-out horn symbol	No honking — common near hospitals and schools
Pedestrians Prohibited	Red circle, walking figure crossed out	Pedestrians may not use this stretch of road
No Parking	Blue circle, red border, single diagonal bar	No parking, but a brief stop to drop off is allowed
No Stopping / Standing	Blue circle, red border, double diagonal bar	No stopping for any reason, even briefly
Compulsory Ahead / Turn	Blue circle, white arrow	A positive instruction — you must travel only in the arrow's direction
Compulsory Keep Left	Blue circle, white left-pointing arrow	Vehicles must pass to the left of the sign or median
Width / Height Limit	Red circle, numeric value with unit	Vehicles exceeding this dimension may not proceed

Two Shades of Blue and Red: Notice that most mandatory signs are red circles telling you what you *must not* do (prohibitory), while a smaller blue-circle group tells you what you *must* do instead (positive instruction). This distinction — red for "don't," blue for "do" — is one of the most useful shortcuts in reading Indian signs quickly.

Part B — Cautionary (Warning) Signs

Around 40 cautionary signs are officially codified under IRC standards. All are triangular, with a red border, apex pointing up, and a black symbol on a white background. Common examples include:

Sign	Meaning
Right / Left Hairpin Bend	An extremely sharp bend ahead, common in hilly terrain
Steep Ascent / Descent	A sharp gradient ahead — manage speed and gearing
Narrow Bridge	The bridge ahead is narrower than the approach road
Road Narrows	The carriageway ahead reduces in width
Pedestrian Crossing	A marked crossing lies ahead — slow down and watch for people
School Ahead	A school lies nearby — expect children near the road
Men at Work	Roadwork or construction activity ahead
Cattle	Animals may be crossing or present on the road
Falling Rocks	A landslide-prone stretch, common in hilly regions
Slippery Road	Reduced tyre grip likely — often near water bodies or shaded stretches
Right / Left Hand Curve	A curve ahead, less sharp than a hairpin bend
Traffic Signal Ahead	An upcoming signal-controlled junction — prepare to slow or stop

Part C — Informatory Signs

Informatory signs are not legally enforceable in the way mandatory signs are, but ignoring them often leads to missed turns, breakdowns, or emergencies. They are rectangular — blue on city and district roads, green on highways and expressways.

Sign	Meaning
Hospital	Blue square with a bed and red cross symbol
First Aid Post	Blue square with a white cross
Petrol Pump	Indicates a fuel station ahead
Parking	Blue square with a white "P," sometimes with a vehicle icon
Destination / Direction Sign	Green board with white text — city names and distances on highways
Route Marker	Shows the highway number you are currently travelling on
Ferry	Indicates a water-crossing service ahead

Part D — Temporary Signs

Temporary signs communicate short-term changes — roadwork, diversions, accidents, or special events. They are typically portable, mounted on stands or barricades, and use high-visibility orange or red colouring with reflective strips so they remain visible at night. Common temporary signage includes "Road Closed," "Diversion," directional arrow boards, and warning lights placed around obstructions.

Part E — Construction Zone Signs

Construction zones combine a cautionary "Men at Work" sign with supporting temporary measures: barricades marking the work boundary, traffic cones channelling vehicles safely around the site, diversion boards showing an alternate route, and often a flagger or traffic police officer directing vehicles manually. Where a flagger's hand signal differs from a posted sign, the flagger's live instruction always takes priority, since it reflects the current, real-time situation.

Part F — School Zone Signs

The triangular "School Ahead" cautionary sign warns drivers that a school is nearby and that children may cross unpredictably. Around such zones, local traffic authorities frequently post additional supplementary plates (such as a locally set lower speed limit or school-hours timing) and may deploy a crossing guard during arrival and dismissal times. Drivers should slow down well before the sign, not at it, since children often appear suddenly and without warning.

Part G — Highway Signs

India's highways use a colour-coded milestone (kilometre stone) system that instantly tells a traveller which authority maintains the road:

Milestone Colour	Road Type
Yellow top, white base	National Highway (NH) — maintained by NHAI / MoRTH
Green top, white base	State Highway (SH) — maintained by the state PWD
Black or blue top, white base	District or city roads
Orange top, white base	Rural / village roads (often under PMGSY)

Direction and distance signs on highways use green backgrounds with white lettering, while route markers display the highway number so drivers can confirm they are on the correct road. Newer access-controlled expressways, such as the Delhi–Mumbai Expressway, have begun introducing numbered exits and international-style green guide signage — a step up from older highway signage conventions.

Part H — Road Markings & Symbols

Beyond lane lines (covered in Module 2), several painted symbols carry specific meanings:

- **Directional Arrows:** Painted on the carriageway to show permitted lane movements — straight, turn, or merge
- **Pedestrian Symbol:** Marks a walkway or crossing area
- **Cycle Symbol:** Marks a dedicated cycle lane or track
- **Chevron Markings:** Arrow-shaped patterns guiding traffic safely around a hazard or central island
- **Hatched Markings:** Diagonal-striped areas that must not be entered, often separating opposing traffic flows or marking a merge zone
- **Rumble Strips:** Raised strips that create vibration and sound to alert drowsy or distracted drivers, often before toll plazas or sharp curves

Part I — Hand Signals

At busy junctions, a traffic police officer's hand signal always overrides an automatic light signal. Common signals include:

- **Stop:** Arm raised, palm facing oncoming traffic
- **Go:** Arm extended, palm down, moved forward
- **Slow Down:** Palm down, moved up and down repeatedly
- **Turn Direction:** Arm pointed toward the permitted direction of travel

Riders and cyclists should also know self-signalling hand gestures for when a vehicle's indicators are not visible or working: arm extended

straight out for a turn in that direction, and arm extended downward with palm facing back to signal slowing or stopping.

Part J — Commonly Misunderstood Signs

Certain sign pairs are consistently confused, even by experienced drivers and RTO learner's licence candidates:

- **No Entry vs. One Way:** No Entry means a specific direction is completely closed to vehicles; One Way means the road itself is open, but only in one direction. The two are often placed together at opposite ends of the same street.
- **No Parking vs. No Stopping:** The single most confused pair in RTO exam question banks. No Parking permits a brief stop to drop off or pick up passengers if the driver stays with the vehicle. No Stopping permits no halt at all, for any reason.
- **Stop vs. Give Way:** A Stop sign demands a complete halt every time, regardless of visible traffic. A Give Way sign only requires yielding if other traffic is actually present.
- **Blue Circle vs. Red Circle Mandatory Signs:** Both are legally binding, but red circles prohibit an action while blue circles command a specific action — mixing up the two can send a driver the opposite way intended.

📝 Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
IRC	Indian Roads Congress — the body that standardises sign and marking design nationwide
Regulatory Sign	A legally binding mandatory sign
Supplementary Plate	A smaller board adding detail below a main sign
Kilometre Stone	A roadside marker showing distance and road type by colour
Route Marker	A sign displaying the number of the highway you are on
Chevron Marking	An arrow-shaped road marking guiding traffic around a hazard
Rumble Strip	A raised road strip that alerts drivers through vibration and sound
Flagger	A person manually directing traffic, typically at a construction site
Hatched Marking	A diagonally striped area that must not be entered by vehicles
Guide Sign	Another name for an informatory sign

🧭 Step-by-Step Understanding

How to Read an Unfamiliar Sign in Three Seconds

1. **Shape first:** Octagon or triangle-down (Stop/Give Way), circle (mandatory), triangle-up (caution), or rectangle (information)?
2. **Colour second:** Red border narrows it to a rule; blue means a positive instruction or facility; green signals a highway destination
3. **Symbol last:** Only now read the specific picture or number inside to get the exact instruction

Approaching a Construction or Temporary Sign Zone

1. Slow down as soon as you see cones, barricades, or an orange warning sign
2. Look for a flagger or police officer — their live signal overrides any posted sign
3. Follow the diversion or lane-shift markings exactly, without cutting across cones
4. Resume normal speed only once you have fully cleared the marked zone

🇮🇳 Real-Life Indian Examples

- **The Kilometre Stone System:** India's roadside milestones are colour-coded by the maintaining authority — yellow for national highways, green for state highways — letting millions of daily travellers instantly judge what speed limit and road standard to expect, without needing a map or app.
- **The Most Confused Exam Question:** RTO learner's licence exam-preparation resources consistently flag "No Parking vs. No Stopping" as the single most frequently mixed-up sign pair nationally, showing how easily two similar-looking blue signs can lead to real fines.
- **The 120 km/h Notification Challenge:** In 2021, the Madras High Court set aside the Union government's 2018 notification permitting 120 km/h speeds on certain stretches, citing safety concerns — a reminder that the number on a mandatory speed-limit sign is a legal instrument that can itself be revised or challenged.
- **Modern Expressway Signage:** Newer access-controlled expressways such as the Delhi–Mumbai Expressway have introduced numbered exits and international-style green destination signage, reflecting a gradual modernisation of how Indian highways guide drivers.

💬 Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: You reach an unfamiliar junction and the sign appears faded and hard to read.
Slow down well before the junction, look for road markings and any nearby traffic as extra clues, and proceed only once you are certain of the right of way.

Scenario 2: You approach a construction zone at night and see a flagger waving you forward, but a temporary sign a little earlier said "Stop."

Follow the flagger's live signal — it reflects the current situation and always overrides a static posted sign in that moment.

Scenario 3: Your two-wheeler's right indicator has stopped working and you need to turn right.
Extend your right arm straight out to signal the turn manually, well before reaching the turning point.

Scenario 4: You see a blue circular sign showing a white arrow pointing left, but your destination is straight ahead.
You must follow the sign and turn left — it is a compulsory instruction, not a suggestion, regardless of your intended destination.

Scenario 5: You notice the kilometre stone beside the road has a green top instead of yellow.
You are now on a state highway, not a national highway — adjust your speed expectation, since the legal limits for the two can differ.

🏛 Government Rules / Guidelines

- **IRC:67-2012 — Code of Practice for Road Signs:** The core Indian Roads Congress standard defining the shape, colour, symbol, and placement of every official road sign.
- **IRC:35 — Code of Practice for Road Markings:** The technical standard governing lane markings, symbols, and pavement markings.
- **MoRTH Sign Standardisation Efforts:** Ongoing national initiatives to replace outdated, non-standard, or ambiguous signage with IRC-compliant boards.
- **State PWD Milestone Maintenance:** Kilometre stones on state highways are installed and maintained by respective state Public Works Departments, while national highway markers fall under NHAI.
- **Black Spot Rectification Programme:** MoRTH's initiative to identify accident-prone stretches and improve their signage, markings, and engineering.
- **Expressway Modernisation:** NHAI's newer expressway projects are progressively adopting international-style numbered exits and green guide signage.

⚖ Laws & Policies

Traffic signs derive their legal force chiefly from the following provisions of the **Motor Vehicles Act, 1988** (as amended in 2019):

KEY LEGAL PROVISIONS

Provision	What It Covers
Section 118	Empowers governments to prescribe standard road signs and signals
Section 119	Duty to obey directions given by a police officer regulating traffic
Section 121	Duty to obey traffic signs and signals

PENALTIES UNDER THE MOTOR VEHICLES (AMENDMENT) ACT, 2019

Violation	Penalty (Approximate)
Ignoring a Stop sign	Fine starting from ₹1,000
Entering a "No Entry" zone	Around ₹500, higher for commercial vehicles
Ignoring a "No Overtaking" sign	₹1,000 or more, depending on the state
Wrong parking (No Parking / No Stopping)	₹500 (light vehicle), ₹1,500 (heavy vehicle), plus towing charges
Ignoring a school zone or speed-limit sign	₹1,000 – ₹2,000, depending on vehicle category
Not obeying a police officer's signal	Fine as prescribed under Section 177

Note: Exact fine amounts vary by state and are periodically revised. Always verify current figures with your state transport department or the Parivahan portal.

📊 Important Statistics (India)

DID YOU KNOW?

Indicator	Figure
Core sign categories under IRC standards	3 — Mandatory, Cautionary, Informatory
Officially codified cautionary/warning signs	Approximately 40
Overspeeding's share of 2022 road accidents	72.3% of accidents, 71.2% of deaths (MoRTH)
Wrong-side driving's share of 2022 accidents	4.9% — the second-highest single cause
Drunk driving, red-light jumping & mobile use combined	7.4% of accidents, 8.3% of deaths (MoRTH, 2022)

Source: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, "Road Accidents in India" — 2022 report; Indian Roads Congress sign classification standards.

✓ Best Practices

- Identify a sign's category by shape and colour before reading the symbol
- Treat every mandatory sign as legally binding, even on a quiet or empty road
- Slow down well in advance when you see a cautionary sign, not right beside it

- Follow a flagger's live hand signal over a static posted sign in construction zones
- Check kilometre stone colours to judge the road type and appropriate speed
- Use manual hand signals if your vehicle's indicators are not visible or working
- Never guess the meaning of an unfamiliar sign — slow down until you are certain

✕ Common Mistakes

- Confusing "No Parking" with "No Stopping" and leaving a vehicle unattended
- Treating a "Give Way" sign as optional when traffic is actually approaching
- Ignoring a "School Ahead" sign because no children are visible at that instant
- Assuming a faded or damaged sign no longer applies
- Cutting through construction cones to save a few seconds
- Mistaking a blue "Compulsory Turn" sign for an optional suggestion
- Not noticing a milestone's colour change when crossing from an NH to an SH

🔍 Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"Cautionary signs are optional since they're not 'orders'"	They are not separately punishable in the same way as mandatory signs, but ignoring them is a leading cause of preventable accidents
"No Entry and One Way mean the same thing"	No Entry closes a direction completely; One Way permits travel only in one direction, and the road stays open
"A flagger's hand signal is just a suggestion near roadwork"	A flagger's live signal carries the same authority as a traffic police officer's signal in that moment
"All mandatory signs are red circles"	Blue circular signs are also mandatory — they instruct a required action rather than prohibiting one
"Kilometre stone colours are just decoration"	They indicate the maintaining authority and road category, both of which affect the legal speed limit

📌 Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Read shape and colour first, symbol second	Don't guess a sign's meaning if you are unsure
Slow down early when you see a cautionary sign	Don't wait until you are right beside it
Follow a flagger's live signal in work zones	Don't rely only on a static sign once a flagger is present
Treat blue "compulsory" signs as binding instructions	Don't assume only red signs are legally enforceable
Check kilometre stone colours on long drives	Don't assume the speed limit stays the same across road types
Use manual hand signals if indicators fail	Don't turn without signalling your intention somehow

🛡 Safety Tips

Reading Signs Quickly

- Scan the road edges continuously, not just directly ahead, for upcoming signage
- In unfamiliar areas, reduce speed slightly so you have more time to read signs

In Construction & School Zones

- Expect sudden pedestrian movement near "Men at Work" and "School Ahead" signs
- Keep a wider-than-usual gap from cones, barricades, and workers

On Highways

- Use kilometre stones to track your progress and confirm you are on the correct route
- Watch for route markers after every major junction to confirm you haven't taken a wrong turn

🎒 Practical Checklist

- [ ] I can identify mandatory, cautionary, and informatory signs by shape and colour
- [ ] I know the difference between No Entry and One Way signs

- [ ] I know the difference between No Parking and No Stopping signs
- [ ] I slow down as soon as I see a cautionary or school zone sign
- [ ] I follow a flagger's signal over a static sign in work zones
- [ ] I check kilometre stone colours on unfamiliar highway routes
- [ ] I use manual hand signals when my indicators are not visible or working
- [ ] I never guess the meaning of a sign I do not recognise

🎓 Quick Revision Notes

- Three sign categories: mandatory (red circle), cautionary (red triangle), informatory (blue/green rectangle)
- Stop = octagon; Give Way = inverted triangle — the two shapes that break the circle rule
- Blue circular signs are also mandatory, but instruct a required action rather than prohibiting one
- Temporary and construction signs use high-visibility orange/red with reflective strips
- Kilometre stone colours: yellow = National Highway, green = State Highway, orange = rural road
- A flagger's live hand signal always overrides a static posted sign
- No Entry ≠ One Way; No Parking ≠ No Stopping — the two most confused sign pairs

🎯 Key Takeaways

1. Every Indian traffic sign is designed to be understood from shape and colour, in an instant
2. Mandatory signs are legally binding; cautionary and informatory signs guide safe judgement
3. Construction, school zone, and temporary signage require extra caution and slower speeds
4. Highway signage — kilometre stones, route markers, direction boards — tells you exactly where you are and what rules apply
5. A small number of sign pairs cause most real-world confusion — knowing them well prevents fines and accidents
6. Reading signs correctly is a practical safety skill, not just an exam requirement

📖 Glossary

- **Cautionary Sign** — A triangular sign warning of a hazard or unusual condition ahead
- **Chevron Marking** — An arrow-shaped road marking guiding traffic around a hazard
- **Flagger** — A person manually directing traffic, typically at a work site
- **Guide Sign** — Another name for an informatory sign
- **IRC** — Indian Roads Congress, the body standardising sign and marking design
- **Kilometre Stone** — A colour-coded roadside marker showing distance and road type
- **Mandatory Sign** — A legally binding regulatory sign, usually a red or blue circle
- **Regulatory Sign** — Another name for a mandatory sign
- **Route Marker** — A sign displaying the number of the highway you are travelling on
- **Supplementary Plate** — A smaller board adding detail below a main sign

? Frequently Asked Questions

1. What are the three main categories of Indian traffic signs?

Mandatory (regulatory), cautionary (warning), and informatory (guide) signs.

2. What shape is a Stop sign in India?

An octagon — one of only two shapes that break the usual circular pattern of mandatory signs.

3. What is the difference between No Entry and One Way signs?

No Entry closes a specific direction completely to vehicles; One Way means the road stays open, but only in one direction.

4. What is the difference between No Parking and No Stopping?

No Parking allows a brief stop to drop off or pick up passengers if the driver remains with the vehicle; No Stopping does not allow any halt at all.

5. What colour are cautionary signs in India?

White background with a red border, in a triangular shape with the apex pointing up.

6. What colour is used for destination signs on highways?

Green background with white lettering, as opposed to blue used on city and district roads.

7. What does a yellow-topped kilometre stone indicate?

That you are travelling on a National Highway, maintained by NHAI.

8. What does a green-topped kilometre stone indicate?

That you are travelling on a State Highway, maintained by the state Public Works Department.

9. Whose signal takes priority in a construction zone — the sign or the flagger?

The flagger's live hand signal always takes priority over a static posted sign.

10. Are blue circular signs mandatory or informatory?

Mandatory. They instruct a required action, such as a compulsory turn, rather than providing general information.

11. How many cautionary signs are officially codified in India?

Approximately 40, under Indian Roads Congress standards.

12. What body standardises road sign design in India?

The Indian Roads Congress (IRC), primarily through IRC:67-2012.

13. What should I do if I can't clearly read a damaged or faded sign?

Slow down, look for supporting clues such as road markings or other traffic, and proceed only once you are certain of the rule.

14. What colour are temporary construction signs usually?

High-visibility orange or red, often with reflective strips for night-time visibility.

15. What should I do if my vehicle's indicator is not working?

Use a manual hand signal — an extended arm in the direction of the turn, or a downward palm to signal slowing or stopping.

16. What does the "Give Way" sign require, compared to "Stop"?

Give Way only requires yielding if traffic is actually present; Stop requires a complete halt every time, regardless of visible traffic.

17. What is a route marker?

A sign displaying the number of the highway you are currently travelling on, helping confirm you are on the correct road.

18. What is the penalty for ignoring a "No Entry" sign?

Typically around ₹500, with higher fines for commercial vehicles, though amounts vary by state.

19. What are hatched road markings?

Diagonally striped areas painted on the road that vehicles must not enter, often used to separate traffic flows or mark a merge zone.

20. Do informatory signs carry legal penalties if ignored?

Not in the same direct way as mandatory signs, but ignoring them can lead to missed turns, breakdowns, or dangerous last-minute manoeuvres.

21. What is a rumble strip?

A raised road strip designed to create vibration and sound, alerting drowsy or distracted drivers, often placed before toll plazas or sharp curves.

22. Where can I find the official standards for Indian road signs?

In IRC:67-2012, published by the Indian Roads Congress, and referenced by MoRTH's official guidance.

🖼 Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For the JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **Shape-colour decision chart** ("What shape? What colour? What does it mean?") → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Mandatory sign gallery** (all major red and blue circular signs) → within "Mandatory Signs"
- **Cautionary sign gallery** (top 15–20 triangular signs) → within "Cautionary Signs"
- **Kilometre stone colour key** (yellow/green/black/orange) → within "Highway Signs"
- **Flowchart: "Reading a Sign in 3 Seconds"** → after "Step-by-Step Understanding"
- **Commonly confused sign pairs, side-by-side** → within "Commonly Misunderstood Signs"

🖷 Official References

- Indian Roads Congress (IRC) — IRC:67-2012, Code of Practice for Road Signs
- Indian Roads Congress (IRC) — IRC:35, Code of Practice for Road Markings
- Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), Government of India — "Road Accidents in India" annual report (2022 edition)
- Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, and Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019 — India Code portal
- National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) — kilometre stone and highway signage standards
- Press Information Bureau (PIB), Government of India — notifications on speed limits and highway signage

🔗 Official Government Website Links

- Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: **https://morth.nic.in**
- Indian Roads Congress: **https://irc.nic.in**
- Parivahan Sewa (licences, e-challans & vehicle records): **https://parivahan.gov.in**
- National Highways Authority of India: **https://nhai.gov.in**
- Press Information Bureau: **https://pib.gov.in**

Emergency Numbers: All-in-one Police/Ambulance/Fire: **112** · NHAI Highway Helpline: **1033**

🏁 Conclusion

Every sign on an Indian road is a small, silent promise — that if you read it correctly, the road will behave the way you expect. Mandatory, cautionary, informatory, and temporary signs, together with markings and hand signals, form a language that every road user shares, regardless of the vehicle they drive or the language they speak.

This is only the beginning of your journey with JanGyan into reading India's roads with confidence. Look twice, read carefully, and remember: **a sign you understand fully is a hazard you never have to face.**

JanGyan — Learn Without Limits
Module 3 of the Road Safety & Public Safety Category